

D347

Advanced Psychiatric Mental Health Care of Children and Adolescents Across Care Settings

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A 9-year-old who plays trumpet in the school band has seven inattentive symptoms that her teacher reports daily. Her parents say she is focused and organized at home and at her weekend art class. Symptoms began at age 8 and have lasted 8 months. Does she meet ADHD criteria?

- A. Yes; music activities show she is overstimulated.
- B. No; symptoms must be present in two or more settings.
- C. Yes; seven symptoms exceed the six required.
- D. No; symptoms must begin before age 7.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A 17-year-old has five inattentive symptoms at home and school that began at age 10 and have caused impairment for over a year. How many symptoms does DSM-5-TR require for someone this age?

- A. Three, because adolescents mask symptoms.
- B. Nine, all symptoms in the domain.
- C. Six, so he does not meet it.
- D. Five, so he meets the symptom threshold.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A 4-year-old whose family recently adopted a puppy meets criteria for ADHD, with problems at preschool and home. Her parents are eager to try medication right away. What is the recommended first-line treatment?

- A. Parent training in behavior management, with medication considered later if impairment persists.
- B. No treatment until age 12.
- C. Rehome the puppy to reduce stimulation.
- D. A stimulant now, since the parents prefer it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An 8-year-old has ADHD with impairment at home and school. What is the recommended treatment?

- A.** Parent training alone, withholding medication.
- B.** School supports only.
- C.** Dietary changes as the main treatment.
- D.** FDA-approved medication along with behavioral therapy and school supports.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

At a well-child visit, a 20-month-old who loves bath time does not respond to his name, does not point to show things, and lines up toy cars for long periods. His older sister talked early. What is the most appropriate next step?

- A.** Order only a hearing test and stop there.
- B.** Wait until age 3 to see if he catches up.
- C.** Complete an autism-specific screen and refer for diagnostic evaluation and early intervention without delay.
- D.** Compare him with his sister and reassure the parents.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

At what ages is autism-specific screening recommended for all toddlers in routine pediatric care?

- A.** Only when parents raise a concern
- B.** 18 and 24 months
- C.** At school entry, age 5
- D.** 9 months

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A 15-year-old on the swim team has moderate-to-severe major depression that has not improved with 8 weeks of CBT. He has no bipolar history. His coach says his times have slowed. Which plan fits current practice?

- A. Avoid all antidepressants in teens.
- B. Focus on improving his swim times.
- C. Add fluoxetine to continued CBT, with close monitoring for suicidal thoughts, especially early.
- D. Start medication and stop CBT.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

During an evaluation, a 7-year-old who is in second grade has bruises in different stages of healing on her back and says her stepfather hits her with a belt. Her mother insists she bruises easily from playing soccer. What must the PMHNP do?

- A. Ask the mother for permission to report.
- B. Report the suspected abuse to child protective services.
- C. Accept the soccer explanation.
- D. Wait until she has proof before reporting.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A 5-year-old who witnessed a car accident has nightmares and clings to his mother. He likes dinosaurs and just started kindergarten. Which therapeutic approach fits his developmental level?

- A. Wait until he can talk about it in detail.
- B. Adult-style insight-oriented talk therapy.
- C. Build therapy only around dinosaurs.
- D. Play-based therapy, with caregiver involvement.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A 16-year-old who works at a pizza shop asks at the start of the first visit, “Will you tell my parents what I say?” Her mother is in the waiting room reading a magazine. What is the best response?

- A.** Explain that what she shares stays private except if there is a risk of serious harm to herself or others, or abuse.
- B.** Promise that nothing will ever be shared.
- C.** Bring her mother in before answering.
- D.** Tell her that parents have the right to know everything.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

An 11-year-old who is good at math often loses his temper, argues with adults, refuses rules, and deliberately annoys his sister for over 6 months. He has not hurt people or animals, destroyed property, or stolen. Which diagnosis fits best?

- A.** Normal behavior for a gifted child
- B.** Conduct disorder
- C.** Oppositional defiant disorder
- D.** Intermittent explosive disorder

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A 14-year-old has bullied classmates, started fights using a bat, set a fire in a garage, and shoplifted repeatedly over the past year. Which diagnosis is most likely?

- A.** Conduct disorder
- B.** Oppositional defiant disorder
- C.** ADHD
- D.** Typical teenage rebellion

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer B Concept 1

A 9-year-old ~~who plays trumpet in the school band~~ has seven inattentive symptoms that her teacher reports daily. Her parents say she is focused and organized at home and at her weekend art class. Symptoms began at age 8 and have lasted 8 months. Does she meet ADHD criteria?

Target word: criteria check **Decides:** Symptoms occur in only one setting.

A	Camouflage	Band participation does not decide the criteria.
B	Correct	Count, onset, and duration are met, but not the settings rule.
C	Dropped element	Leaves out the two-setting requirement.
D	Wrong stem number	DSM-5-TR requires onset before 12.

2. Answer D Concept 1 · transfer

A 17-year-old has five inattentive symptoms at home and school that began at age 10 and have caused impairment for over a year. How many symptoms does DSM-5-TR require for someone this age?

Target word: symptom threshold at 17+ **Decides:** Five symptoms at age 17 and older.

A	Inverted operation	Lowers the threshold further than DSM-5-TR allows.
B	Absolute language	Not all nine are required.
C	Confusion set	Six applies to children under 17.
D	Correct	The threshold drops to five for ages 17 and up.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A 4-year-old ~~whose family recently adopted a puppy~~ meets criteria for ADHD, with problems at preschool and home. Her parents are eager to try medication right away. What is the recommended first-line treatment?

Target word: preschool first-line **Decides:** Age 4.

A	Correct	Behavioral parent training is first-line for ages 4-5.
B	Absolute language	Impairing ADHD in preschool warrants intervention.
C	Camouflage	The pet is not the treatment target.
D	Adjacent category	That is first-line for school-age children, not preschoolers.

4. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

An 8-year-old has ADHD with impairment at home and school. What is the recommended treatment?

Target word: school-age first-line **Decides:** Age 6+ uses medication plus behavioral supports.

A	Inverted operation	Applies the preschool approach to a school-age child.
B	Dropped element	Leaves out medication.
C	Adjacent category	Not a first-line treatment.
D	Correct	Combined approach is recommended for school-age children.

5. Answer C Concept 3

At a well-child visit, a 20-month-old ~~who loves bath time~~ does not respond to his name, does not point to show things, and lines up toy cars for long periods. ~~His older sister talked early.~~ What is the most appropriate next step?

Target word: action on red flags **Decides:** Multiple autism red flags.

A	Dropped element	Hearing should be checked, but screening and referral are still needed.
B	Inverted operation	Delays early intervention.
C	Correct	Red flags warrant prompt referral.
D	Camouflage	A sibling's pace does not decide this.

6. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

At what ages is autism-specific screening recommended for all toddlers in routine pediatric care?

Target word: screening schedule **Decides:** AAP recommendation.

A	Dropped element	Screening is universal.
B	Correct	Standard autism-specific screening ages.
C	Wrong stem number	Too late for early intervention.
D	Adjacent category	A general developmental screening visit.

7. Answer C Concept 4

A 15-year-old ~~on the swim team~~ has moderate-to-severe major depression that has not improved with 8 weeks of CBT. He has no bipolar history. ~~His coach says his times have slowed.~~ Which plan fits current practice?

Target word: medication choice and monitoring **Decides:** Adolescent MDD after psychotherapy alone.

A	Absolute language	Benefits usually outweigh risks with monitoring.
B	Camouflage	Athletic performance is not the treatment target.
C	Correct	FDA-approved for youth; boxed warning requires monitoring.
D	Dropped element	Combination is more effective.

8. Answer B Concept 5

During an evaluation, a 7-year-old ~~who is in second grade~~ has bruises in different stages of healing on her back and says her stepfather hits her with a belt. Her mother insists she bruises easily from playing soccer. What must the PMHNP do?

Target word: reporting duty **Decides:** Reasonable suspicion of abuse.

A	Adjacent category	Parental permission is not needed.
B	Correct	Reasonable suspicion triggers mandated reporting.
C	Camouflage	The mother's explanation does not remove the child's disclosure.
D	Dropped element	Proof is not required.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A 5-year-old who witnessed a car accident has nightmares and clings to his mother. ~~He likes dinosaurs and just started kindergarten.~~ Which therapeutic approach fits his developmental level?

Target word: developmentally matched approach **Decides:** Age 5 communicates through play.

A	Inverted operation	Delays care and ignores play as communication.
B	Adjacent category	Relies on verbal skills he does not yet have.
C	Camouflage	His interests can help engagement but do not define the approach.
D	Correct	Young children process experiences through play.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A 16-year-old ~~who works at a pizza shop~~ asks at the start of the first visit, "Will you tell my parents what I say?" Her mother is in the waiting room ~~reading a magazine.~~ What is the best response?

Target word: limits of confidentiality **Decides:** Explain confidentiality and its limits up front.

A	Correct	Clear limits build trust and protect safety.
B	Absolute language	Safety exceptions exist.
C	Dropped element	Leaves the question unanswered and ignores the teen's concern.
D	Inverted operation	Undermines trust and ignores adolescent privacy protections.

11. Answer C Concept 8

An 11-year-old ~~who is good at math~~ often loses his temper, argues with adults, refuses rules, and deliberately annoys his sister for over 6 months. He has not hurt people or animals, destroyed property, or stolen. Which diagnosis fits best?

Target word: ODD vs. CD **Decides:** Defiance without violating others' rights.

A	Camouflage	Math skills do not explain six months of impairing defiance.
B	Confusion set	Requires violating others' rights or major rules.
C	Correct	Angry, argumentative, defiant pattern without aggression or property violation.
D	Adjacent category	Involves recurrent aggressive outbursts.

12. Answer A Concept 8 · transfer

A 14-year-old has bullied classmates, started fights using a bat, set a fire in a garage, and shoplifted repeatedly over the past year. Which diagnosis is most likely?

Target word: reverse: identify CD **Decides:** Aggression, destruction, theft.

A	Correct	Violates others' rights and major rules.
B	Confusion set	ODD does not include aggression, fire-setting, or theft.
C	Adjacent category	May co-occur but does not explain these behaviors.
D	Inverted operation	Minimizes serious rule violations.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	3	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	7	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	ADHD diagnostic criteria	Six or more symptoms of inattention and/or hyperactivity-impulsivity (five for age 17+) for at least 6 months, several present before age 12, in two or more settings, with impairment.	Diagnosing when symptoms appear in only one setting, or requiring six symptoms in older adolescents.	Symptom count, age, duration, and where the symptoms occur.
2	Age-based ADHD treatment	For preschoolers (ages 4-5), parent training in behavior management is first-line before medication; for school-age children and teens, FDA-approved medication plus behavioral and school supports.	Starting stimulants first in a 4-year-old, or withholding medication from school-age children.	The child's age in an ADHD treatment question.
3	Autism screening and early signs	Autism-specific screening (e.g., M-CHAT-R/F) is recommended at 18 and 24 months; red flags include no response to name, no pointing or joint attention, and repetitive behaviors, which warrant referral without waiting.	Waiting to see if the child grows out of it.	A toddler with social-communication gaps.
4	Antidepressants in youth	Fluoxetine (age 8+) and escitalopram (12+) are FDA-approved for youth depression; combine with psychotherapy such as CBT and monitor closely for suicidal thinking because of the boxed warning.	Avoiding antidepressants entirely or starting without a monitoring plan.	Moderate-to-severe depression in a teen and a medication choice.
5	Mandated reporting	Clinicians must report reasonable suspicion of child abuse or neglect to child protective services; proof or parental permission is not required.	Waiting to gather proof or confronting the parent first.	An injury or disclosure that raises suspicion.
6	Developmentally matched therapy	Young children express feelings through play, so play-based therapy fits; adolescents are working on identity and autonomy (Erikson: identity vs. role confusion).	Using adult talk therapy with a preschooler.	A child's age and a choice of approach.
7	Confidentiality with adolescents	Explain the limits of confidentiality at the start: what teens share is private except when there is risk of serious harm to self or others or abuse.	Promising total secrecy or telling parents everything.	A teen asks whether their parents will be told.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
8	ODD vs. conduct disorder	ODD is a pattern of angry/irritable mood and argumentative, defiant, or vindictive behavior; conduct disorder involves violating others' rights or major rules (aggression, destruction, theft, serious rule-breaking).	Calling any defiance conduct disorder, or missing aggression to people or animals.	Whether the behavior harms others or property.

Course scope (public description): Advanced Psychiatric Mental Health Care of Children and Adolescents across Care Settings prepares students to provide evidence-based mental healthcare for children, adolescents, and families. This course guides students through the application of age and developmentally appropriate advanced practice health assessment knowledge and diagnostic reasoning skills for children, adolescents, and families experiencing complex mental health issues. This course helps students develop treatment plans to manage specific mental health disorders through the use of psychotherapeutic treatment modalities, psychopharmacology, and community resources. This course also covers the influences of family dynamics and societal norms on mental health progression and recovery. The following are prerequisites for this course: all MSN Core courses, Advanced Pathophysiology for the Advanced Practice Nurse, Advanced Pharmacology for the Advanced Practice Nurse, and Advanced Health Assessment for the Advanced Practice Nurse.